



Farming country

The image of the agricultural Midwest is so firmly established that it has its own place in popular culture: Rodgers and Hammerstein's *Oklahoma* celebrates corn that grows "as high as an elephant's eye," while the farmlands of Kansas play a featured part in both *The Wizard of Oz* and *Little House on the Prairie*.

MAJOR CROPS

Although a wide range of crops is grown in this area, the three most important are wheat, soy beans, and corn. Historical evidence suggests that grain of some kind has been planted here since about 1840.



1 Wheat

Kansas—"the wheat state"—is the country's leading producer of the grain, with roughly one-third of the state's farms devoted to this crop alone.



2 Soy beans

Half the entire world soy-bean crop comes from the United States, and most of this is grown in the Midwest. This large farm is in Wisconsin.



3 Corn

Over a third of all the corn grown worldwide comes from the Midwest region, which is sometimes known as the "Heartland."

DAIRY FARMING

Widely known as "Dairyland," Wisconsin is home to as many cows as people—about four million in each case. As well as milk, vast amounts of butter and cheese are made here, often by farming families descended from the Swedish and German immigrants who poured into the state at the end of the 19th century.

Organic farming as practiced by these Wisconsin-based enthusiasts is the fastest-growing agricultural sector in the country.

